# Wei Yang Tham

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Acceleration Consortium | Rotman School of Management

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## Academic Appointments

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|---|---|
| Staff Scientist, University of Toronto | 2024 - present |
| Research Scientist, Harvard Business School | 2022 - 2024 |
| Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard Business School | 2019 - 2022 |
| Graduate Research Assistant for Bruce Weinberg and David Blau, The Ohio State University | 2015 - 2019 |

## Education

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|---|---|
| Ph.D. in Economics, The Ohio State University | Aug 2019 |
| M.A. in Economics, The Ohio State University | Jun 2014 |
| B.A. in Economics, Rice University | Jun 2013 |

## Publications

Scientific Talent Leaks Out of Funding Gaps (*Review of Economics and Statistics*, forthcoming)
with Joseph Staudt, Elisabeth Perlman, and Stephanie Cheng
*NBER SI 2022 (Innovation), NBER SI 2024 (Science of Science Funding)*
Coverage: *Marginal Revolution*; *Good Science Project*; *Nature (Career Feature)*; *Nature (News)*; *STAT News*
Related policy memo: *The Talent Cost of Research Funding Delays*

Money, Time, and Grant Design (*American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 2026)
with Kyle Myers
*NBER SI 2023 (Science of Science Funding)*
Coverage: *Nature*

The National Survey of Academic Researchers: New Facts and Data (*PLOS ONE*, 2026)
with Kyle Myers, Jerry Thursby, Marie Thursby, Nina Cohodes, Karim Lakhani, Rachel Mural, and Yilun Xu
Coverage: *Nature*

Science, Interrupted: Funding Delays Reduce Research Activity but Having More Grants Helps (*PLOS ONE*, 2023)

Unequal Effects of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Scientists (*Nature Human Behaviour*, 2020)
with Kyle R. Myers, Yian Yin, Nina Cohodes, Jerry G. Thursby, Marie C. Thursby, Peter Schiffer, Joseph T. Walsh, Karim R. Lakhani, and Dashun Wang

## Working Papers

Productivity Beliefs and Efficiency in Science (submitted)
with Fabio Bertolotti and Kyle Myers

Database, Methodological Tools, and Research Opportunities: Creative Destruction Lab and Early-Stage Technology Ventures
with Amir Sariri, Evgenia Gatov, Geneva Neal, Kyle Robinson, Sonia Sennik, Michael Vertolli, and Avi Goldfarb

## Research in Progress

Estimating the Scientific Production Function
with Jeff Qiu and Bruce Weinberg

The Effect of Temporary Colocation on Knowledge Flows: Evidence from NIH Study Sections (slides)

Reproducibility and Automation in Science
with Ilya Yakavets, Yimu Zhao, Mohammad Nazeri, Sheldon Mei, Daniel Lin, Sonia Azimi Dijvejin, and Avi Goldfarb

## Policy Memos & White Papers

The Talent Cost of Research Funding Delays (*PEER Center*, 2026)

Measuring Innovation in Science (*NBER-IFS White Papers on the Value of Medical Research*)

## Teaching Experience

Department of Economics, The Ohio State University

ECON 2367.02 Economic Issues in the United States — Fall 2017
Independent Instructor

ECON 2002.01 Principles of Macroeconomics — Fall 2016
Teaching Assistant

ECON 2001.01 Principles of Microeconomics — Fall 2014
Teaching Assistant

## Grants, Fellowships, & Awards

Fellow, NBER-IFS Value of Health Research Network ($10,000) — 2017
University Fellowship, Graduate School at The Ohio State University — 2013-2014

## Presentations

* *indicates coauthor presented*

**2026**
Georgia Tech, Carter School of Public Policy

**2025**
Accelerate Conference

**2023**
NBER Innovation Information Initiative (I3) Technical Working Group*
The Ohio State University Applied Micro Seminar
The Growth Lab (Harvard Kennedy School)
Advances with Field Experiments (AFE) 2023 Conference
AIEA-NBER Conference 2023
NBER Summer Institute 2023, Science of Science Funding
International Conference on the Science of Science and Innovation (ICSSI)
UMass Amherst Applied Micro Workshop
DRUID
BSE Summer Forum, Economics of Science and Innovation*

**2022**
NBER Summer Institute 2022, Innovation
DRUID
Midwest Economics Association Conference
NBER Investments in Early Career Scientists Meeting (April 2022)
Society of Labor Economists, 27th Annual Meeting

**2021**
Western Economic Association Conference
Evidence for Science Policy – UMETRICS in Action Series

**2020**
Panel on *Doing science in times of crisis: Science studies perspectives on COVID-19*, 2nd edition
14th Workshop on the Organisation, Economics and Policy of Scientific Research at the Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition
Eastern Economic Association Conference

**2019**
2nd Research on Innovation, Science and Entrepreneurship Workshop at the Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition
MTEI Research Seminar, EPFL (École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne)

**2018**
Department of Economics, SUNY Albany
Department of Economics, The Ohio State University
Census ARiS Brown Bag
13th Meeting of the Urban Economics Association
Value of Medical Research Network Meeting
Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting (poster)
Midwest Economics Association Conference

## Refereeing

JPE Micro; Science; PNAS; Economic Journal; Economic Inquiry; Industrial and Labor Relations Review; Regional Science and Urban Economics; Research Policy; Studies in Higher Education

## Leadership

Founder and President of Economics Graduate Student Society 2016 - 2018

## Skills

R, Git, Stata, SQL, MATLAB, Unix (basic)
Languages: English (native), Chinese (fluent), French (basic)

## Citizenship

Singapore

## References

Professor Avi Goldfarb E-mail: agoldfarb@rotman.utoronto.ca
Rotman School of Management
University of Toronto

Professor Kyle R. Myers E-mail: kmyers@hbs.edu
Technology and Operations Management Unit
Harvard Business School

Professor Bruce A. Weinberg E-mail: weinberg.27@osu.edu
Department of Economics
The Ohio State University